Fantod Overview

COMP 283

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Game Type

Fantod is a platform-style, top-down, side-scrolling game set on a Long Earth. The game is a 2D horizontal side-scroller, with a top-down perspective. The player controls a character in a cyberpunk setting. The gameplay focuses on platforming, exploration, and combat, with the player navigating through various environments while encountering enemies and obstacles. The game features a mix of 2D pixel art elements and modern gameplay mechanics, including a dynamic lighting system and procedural generation for certain levels. The game's development process has been iterative, with the creator making significant changes to the core gameplay loop and adding new features and mechanics based on feedback and testing.

The game is developed using Godot Engine, an open-source, cross-platform game engine. The choice of Godot allows for flexibility in development and the ability to create a 2D game with modern gameplay mechanics. The engine's node-based architecture and its support for various programming languages, including GDScript, have been instrumental in the development process, allowing for rapid prototyping and iteration on the game's mechanics and features.

The inspiration for Fantod comes from various sources, including classic 2D platformers and cyberpunk fiction. The game aims to blend these influences with modern gameplay mechanics and a unique art style. The development team is also exploring the use of procedural generation for certain aspects of the game, such as the layout of levels or the placement of enemies and obstacles, to create a more dynamic and replayable experience.

Settings, Characters, and World Elements.

The setting for Fantod features a dystopian cyberpunk aesthetic, with a dark and gritty atmosphere. The game takes place in a future where technology has advanced to the point where it has become deeply integrated into society, but with the negative consequences of this integration being evident in the form of pollution, social inequality, and the dehumanizing effects of technology. The game's environments are designed to reflect this setting, with a mix of high-tech elements and decay, such as abandoned factories, neon-lit streets, and overgrowth in urban areas.

Game characters in the 2D platformer Fantod include the protagonist, who is the player character, and various enemies and obstacles that the player must overcome. The protagonist's design is not specified in the provided information, but it is implied that the character is a cyberpunk-style character, possibly with a dystopian or post-apocalyptic theme.

The lore of the game is not fully explored in the provided information, but it is implied that the game's world has a rich history and backstory, with the player being able to uncover this information through exploration and interaction with the game's environment.

Objectives and Play Action.

The game's objective is to guide a character through various environments, overcoming obstacles and enemies, and reaching the end of each level. The player must navigate through the game's environments, using platforming mechanics to jump, climb, and avoid hazards. The game may also include puzzle elements or boss fights that require the player to use their character's abilities and skills to overcome challenges.

The core of the gameplay is expected to revolve around exploration, platforming, and combat. The player will be able to interact with various elements in the game world, such as collecting items, activating switches, and interacting with non-player characters (NPCs). The game may also include a story or narrative element, with the player's actions and choices affecting the outcome of the story.

The game's mechanics are designed to be intuitive and easy to learn, with the player being able to quickly pick up the controls and start playing. The game may also include a tutorial or introductory level to help the player learn the basic mechanics and controls of the game.

Target Demographic

The target demographic for Fantod is not specified in the provided information. However, based on the game's cyberpunk setting and its focus on platforming and exploration, it is likely that the game will appeal to players who enjoy these genres and are interested in the cyberpunk aesthetic. The game may also appeal to players who are looking for a challenging and immersive experience, with the game's mechanics and story being designed to keep players engaged and interested.

Special or Unique Features.

- Unique Art Style
  - The 2D platformer's unique art style is one of its most distinctive features. The game's art style is described as a blend of modern and classic elements, with the game's environments and characters having a dark and gritty aesthetic that is reminiscent of classic cyberpunk media.
- Dynamic Lighting System
  - The game's lighting system is a key feature that adds depth and atmosphere to the game's environments. The system allows for dynamic lighting effects, such as shadows and reflections, that enhance the game's visual quality and immersion.
- Procedural Generation
  - The game may also include procedural generation for certain aspects of the game, such as the layout of levels or the placement of enemies and obstacles. This feature would allow for a more dynamic and replayable experience, with the game's environments and challenges changing each time the player plays the game.

Development Considerations.

The following is being analyzed by one of the developers known for creating a fitting game. Which consists of: Feasibility, Resources, Market Trends, Target Audience and Engagement, and Monetization.

Feasibility: The feasibility of developing Fantod depends on the creator's skill and experience with game development, the availability of resources and tools, and the market demand for such a game. The creator's skill and experience with game development will be a key factor in the feasibility of the project, as it will require a high level of technical expertise and knowledge of the game development process.

The availability of resources and tools will also be a key factor in the feasibility of the project, as it will require access to the necessary software and hardware to develop the game, as well as the time and resources to create the game's assets and mechanics.

The market demand for such a game will also be a key factor in the feasibility of the project, as it will need to attract a sufficient number of players to be profitable. The creator will need to conduct market research to determine the demand for such a game and the target audience for the game.

Resources: The creator will need to have a high level of technical expertise and knowledge of the game development process, as well as the time and resources to create the game's assets and mechanics. The creator may also need to hire additional staff or collaborators to help with the development process, such as artists, programmers, and sound designers.

Market Trends: The market for cyberpunk-themed games has been growing in recent years, with many popular titles in the genre such as Cyberpunk 2077 and The Ascent. The creator may need to conduct market research to determine the current trends and preferences in the cyberpunk genre, and to identify any gaps in the market that could be filled by Fantod.

Target Audience and Engagement: The target audience for Fantod will depend on the creator's vision for the game and the market research conducted. The creator may need to consider the age, gender, and interests of the target audience, and to develop a marketing strategy that will effectively reach and engage the target audience.

Monetization: The creator will need to consider the monetization strategy for Fantod, such as selling the game outright, offering in-game purchases, or using a subscription model. The creator may also need to consider the pricing of the game, and to conduct market research to determine the optimal price point for the game.

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Game Type

Fantod is a science fiction, dystopian, role-playing game set on a dying Earth. The gameplay involves elements of colony survival simulators, tabletop games, exploration simulators, and role-playing games. The gameplay follows a similar framework to FrostPunk's mechanics, with the main story having a limited timeframe in which the player attempts to maintain a population, with a variety of paths and decisions that change the outcome of the game end. The game features a similar morale and discontent system, food, and development systems. Fantod differs in setting; the world is the open seas and allows for a much larger element for exploration to survive and interact with other locations and factions.

The main gameplay element is puzzle solving, which involves managing scarcity and exploring efficiently. The game has a hierarchy of priorities, with the crew's order at the top, followed by supplies, safety, and long-term goals. Fantod is designed to be replayed several times to explore different morale or exploration paths.

The success of FrostPunk and its recent sequel release is indicative that games with this element of gameplay and dystopian setting are a growing niche. In terms of deep-sea horror, several independent and major games have been released. An early first example could be the first two entries in the Bioshock series, while more recent examples could include Barotrauma, Iron Lung, and Subnautica.

Settings, Characters, and World Elements.

The world of Fantod features dark themes of survival, sacrifice, social structures, and a darker aspect of humanity but is undercut with a certain degree of silliness to break the tension throughout. The game features three main factions (submariners, research stations, and air breathers), that have different outlooks and allegiances based on historical contexts before the war, such as Mischeo or Swath leanings.

The Envelop itself features three unique classes that all play an integral part in keeping the submarine alive. The other surviving submarine fleets introduce options to collaborate or compete with different ideological factions and technologies. Land-dwellers are ultimately doomed but act as valuable depots for old-world technology. The research stations provide an avenue for understanding the environment and developing technology.

Apart from human life, it has mutated in new and horrifying ways, with each year providing unique features to the sea life. Some of the major factions of animals are a whale, crustaceans, plants, and man-fish.

The motif of the game is that wanton scientific progress can lead to disaster. This motif will reoccur in several decision-based gameplay elements. For example, using faster research methods could require a cost of life or result in negative effects.

Objectives and Play Action.

The story mechanics within the Fantod universe are loosely coupled. It will be possible for the player to miss important story elements or explanations that can prove useful in gameplay later. In many ways, the player is set up to fail through a lack of knowledge on their first playthrough. They will need multiple attempts to develop a sense of the world and achieve a good ending. Examples of these elements could include the order or path of exploration the player chooses, which edicts to invoke and when knowing which settlements are trustworthy or not.

The player will always feel pushed and pressed for time by the storm, exploring all locations will be impossible in most situations. False explanations and information on the new world will be found through a playthrough to further obfuscate the ideal paths and playstyles. Misinformation and unreliable narrators will be a major element within the game. For example, some upgrades or research fields will result in negative buffs throughout the game. Some research may be crackpot science designed to destroy the ship or overthrow the captain (perpetual motion, for example).

Target Demographic

The target demographic for Fantod would be adults who enjoy survival horror games with gameplay elements centered on managing and developing a virtual population with various needs. People who enjoy lore that has to be pieced together to gain any coherence will enjoy Fantod. Games that adopt a similar mechanic for indirect lore and storytelling are the Dark Souls series and FrostPunk.

Special or Unique Features.

- Unique World
  - Fantod features a unique apocalypse that steps away from the typical nuclear, zombie, or pandemic-based scenarios.
- Realistic submarine mechanics and details.
  - Fantod will teach the player a variety of sea lingo present in the real world while also learning about the functions, mechanics, and limitations of submarines.
- Worldwide Exploration
  - Cultural elements from across the world can be implemented for a diverse range of characters and story elements. People may be more interested in purchasing a game that features their country.

Development Considerations.

- The Envelop interior and exterior will be the most detailed models within the game. Other vessels will most likely have exterior views only, except for occassional glimpses of small sections.
- The exterior will be a 3-D model that can be placed within the map, while the interior will most likely be represented by interface screens and drawn representations.
- The Sea
- The Envelop observed at the closest range will show the immediate surroundings on a 3-D map, but medium and long-range viewing will be represented in 2-D interfaces.
- Lore Development
- Implementing a multi-path story system will require a large amount of organization. Choosing locations for research stations and settlements should be logically spread out. The year system will also require development for each stage, requiring aesthetic modifications for the ocean and Envelop.
- Sea life will be represented with drawn art. The Whale is only seen on the starting screen.